# Foundations of ABA
# &
# The Role of the Behavior Technician

Game pin: 80265 - Waiting for players - Kahoot!

# Learning Objectives

- Learn key responsibilities of a Behavior Technician
- Understand the principles of ABA and its application
- Become familiar with reinforcement strategies and data collection
- Respond to common scenarios ethically and effectively

# The Role of the Behavior Technician

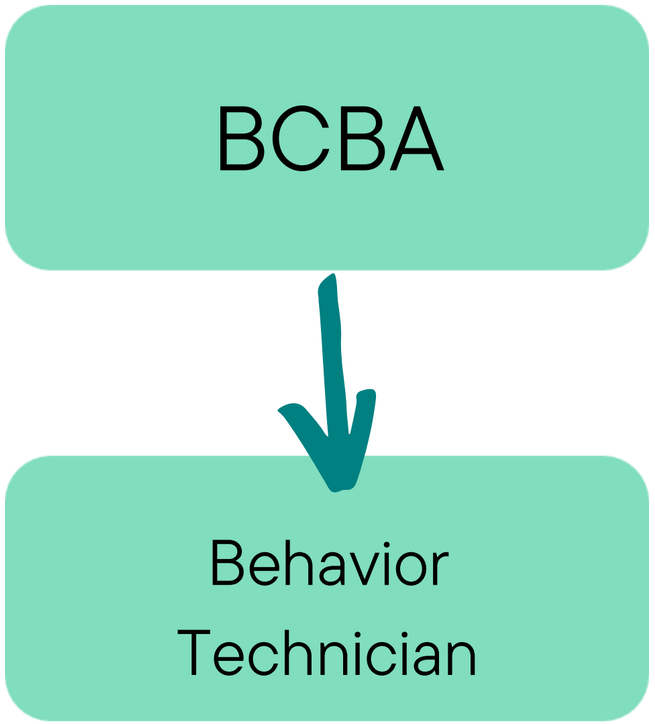
- Implement programming outlined in child's treatment plan
- Collect and record data accurately
- Communicate effectively with team

# What makes a great BT?

- Patience
- Consistency
- Curiosity and willingness to learn
- Ethics and professionalism

# BT Scope of Practice

- What BTs can and cannot do
- When to consult your supervisor



# BT Scope of Practice

Learning scenario:

You are holding a 1:1 session with a client, and your supervisor is not there. When working on matching, you notice the client gets the first 3 trials right, so you decide they have mastered that skill, and work on a new target.

# BT Scope of Practice

Learning scenario:

You are at a 1:1 session and your client begins engaging in a new behavior, kicking. You don't have a written plan for this from your BCBA, so you work through it using strategies you've already been trained on.

Do you report this to your BCBA?

# What is ABA?

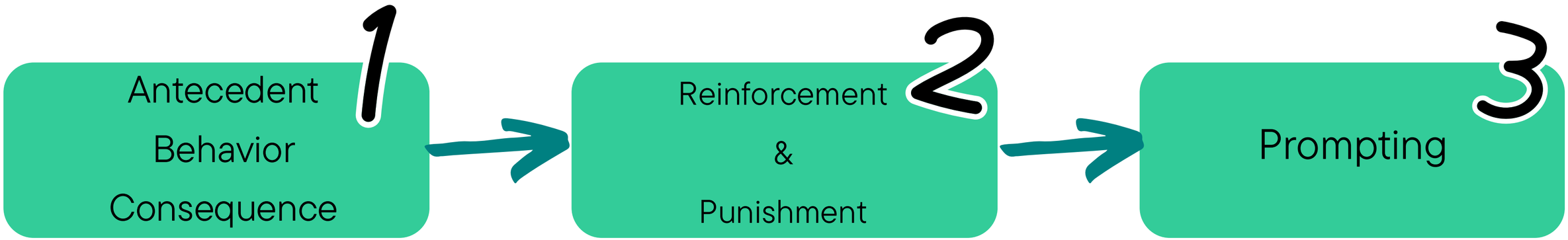
Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA) is a science of learning and behavior that aims to improve socially significant behaviors.

oh hey!

Dr. Ivar Lovaas

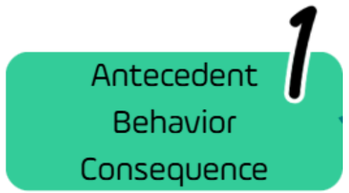
B.F Skinner

# Core Concepts of ABA



# A-B-Cs of Behavior

- Antecedent - what happens directly before the behavior?
- Behavior - the observable, measurable action the client engages in
- Consequence - what happens directly after the behavior?



# A-B-Cs of Behavior

## Let's practice!

- You will need a piece of paper & pencil
- We are looking at the A, B & C

Antecedent
Behavior
Consequence

# Reinforcement

A consequence that increases the likelihood of the behavior occurring again in the future.

This can be either Positive OR Negative reinforcement

# Reinforcement

This can be either Positive OR Negative reinforcement

**Positive = Add**

- Praise
- Tangible Items
- Tokens
- Attention

**Negative = Remove**

- Aversive noise
- Unwanted Item
- Can be seen as "relief"

# Positive Reinforcement – How does this work?

1. Identify a behavior you want to increase. (Let's say it's a learner sitting at the table.)

2. Choose a reinforcer that is meaningful to the person. (Maybe the child loves playdoh, so that becomes the tangible "reward".)

3. Consistently provide the reward immediately after the desired behavior. (Sitting nicely? Playdoh time!)

4. Review how implementation worked. (Does playdoh time after sitting nicely successfully motivate the learner to sit again the next time? If so, playdoh is a reinforcer.

# Negative Reinforcement – How does this work?

1. Identify an unwanted stimulus. Maybe it's the broccoli on the child's plate.

2. Recognize the behavior that you want to see increase that could remove this unwanted stimulus, like eating the chicken.

3. Reinforce this behavior by removing the broccoli when the child eats all of the chicken, thus increasing the likelihood

# Punishment

A consequence that decreases the likelihood of the behavior occurring again.

This can be either Positive OR Negative punishment

# Positive Punishment – How does this work?

1. Identify the behavior to decrease, like a child hitting a sibling.

2. Introduce an aversive consequence. When the hitting happens, extra chores can serve as the consequence.

3. Of course, ensure the punishment is appropriate and ethical.

4.Remember – it is only “punishment” if it decreases the future instances of the hitting behavior.

# Negative Punishment – How does this work?

1. Identify the undesired behavior, such as a student hitting a friend.

2. Remove a privilege or preferred item, like taking away their fidget toy.

3. Apply this consistently to decrease the behavior, but always ensure it's fair and not overly harsh.

4. If this strategy works over time to decrease problem behavior, then it would be considered negative punishment.

# Reinforcement & Punishment

## Let's recap!

| | INCREASE future likelihood of behavior | DECREASE future likelihood of behavior |
|---|---|---|
| **Add things** | Positive Reinforcement | Positive Punishment |
| **Take things away** | Negative Reinforcement | Negative Punishment |

# Prompting

Now that we talked about what happens after the behavior, let's back up a little bit!

# Prompting – what is it?

- A cue or assistance given to encourage a desired behavior

- This strategy is typically applied after the instruction has been given but before the learner's response

# Prompting – How do we use it?

**Errorless learning** – prompting before the learner gets the chance to get it wrong

OR

**Error correction** – prompting once the learner has had a chance to get it wrong

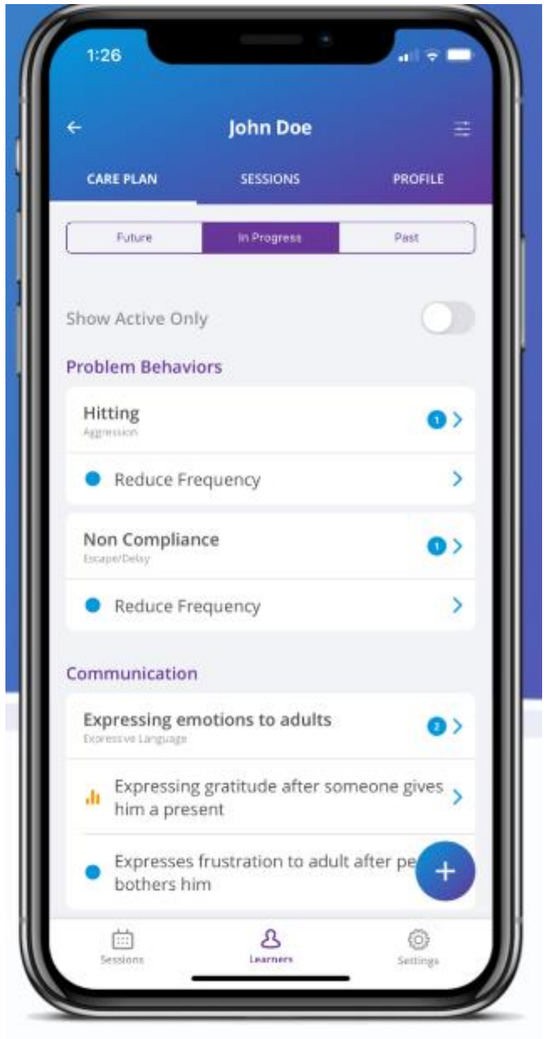
We will dive further into this during client-specific training ☺

# Data Collection

Why does data matter in ABA?

Types of data
- Frequency
- Duration
- ABC
- Interval

What does this look like at Tealway?



# Documentation

Documentation happens at the end of every session

Why is this important?

- Notes are seen by many different people
- This ensures that you have completed your role

# Documentation

Documentation happens at the end of every session

What should my note look like?

- Accuracy
- Neutrality
- Time sensitive

# Documentation

## Let’s practice!

You just completed a session with Maddie, she engaged in hitting and kicking, but you followed the treatment plan. She worked on matching and sorting programs where she responded to you about half of the time.

# Ethics

What is my role in ethics as a BT?

- BACB code of ethics
- Confidentiality (HIPAA)
- Respect and cultural sensitivity

BACB code of ethics

# Ethics

## Let's practice!

There are two BTs on your client's team. When you arrive at session, Mom starts telling you how bad the other BT is, and how much they dislike them.

What is your response?

# Safety & Emergency Response

## What if there is a safety concern?

- Immediate responsibilities
  - How do you work through something new?
  - Who do I notify?
- Documentation
  - Safety should *always* be documented in session note & a separate incident report

# Safety & Emergency Response

## What if there is a larger concern?

- We are mandated reporters in the role as a BT

New York State Mandated Reporter Resource Center - Mandated Reporters

Mandated Reporter SCR Call Tip Sheet.pdf

# Questions?

What are next steps?